

INTERPROFESSIONAL COLLABORATION CHECKLIST

A GUIDE FOR SLPs, BCBAs, AND SPECIAL EDUCATORS

This checklist is designed to foster a culture of **mutual respect** and **integrated care** within your team. Use these prompts during team meetings or case reviews to ensure we are prioritizing the client's outcomes over disciplinary silos.

1. ESTABLISHING VALUES & ETHICS

- ☐ Practice Cultural Humility: Am I being "other-oriented" and avoiding assumptions about my colleagues' backgrounds or methods?
- ☐ Validate Opinions: Have I listened to alternate professional opinions with integrity, even if they differ from my own?
- ☐ Shared Goals: Are we working toward a joint outcome for the learner, or just isolated goals for our specific sessions?

2. CLARIFYING ROLES & COMPETENCIES

- ☐ Define My Role: Have I clearly communicated my specific responsibilities and what I can contribute to this learner's team?
- ☐ Acknowledge Limitations: Am I practicing within my Scope of Competence, and have I been candid about the limits of my training?
- ☐ Seek Consultation: Have I consulted with my colleagues for areas outside my standard training (e.g., a BCBA asking an SLP about sound acquisition or swallowing)?

3. COMMUNICATION & TEAMWORK

- ☐ Bridge the Jargon: Have we acknowledged that we might use different terms for similar concepts (e.g., "communicative intent" vs. "verbal operant")? **See Table
- ☐ Positive Dialogue: Is my communication proactive and oriented toward resolving disagreements rather than criticizing another discipline?
- ☐ Evidence-Based Decisions: Are we using data and scientific research to guide our choices rather than just individual clinical opinions?

4. INTEGRATED ACTION

- ☐ Support the Team Plan: Even if a group decision wasn't my first choice, am I committed to helping carry out the team's unified plan?
- ☐ Reduce Redundancy: Are we coordinating our treatments to prevent unnecessary replication or conflicting instructions for the learner?

"BCBAs bring strengths in looking at communication through environment-behavior relations."

"SLPs bring a deep understanding of language structures like syntax, phonology, and developmental sequences."

5. THE INTERPROFESSIONAL LANGUAGE BRIDGE

This "Cheat Sheet" is designed to help BCBA's and SLPs recognize when they are talking about the same concepts using different professional terms. Use this to build common ground during team meetings.

When a BCBA says...	An SLP might say...	The Shared Concept
Mand	Requesting	Asking for things, actions, or assistance to get a need met.
Tact	Labeling	Naming or commenting on things in the environment to share an experience.
Intraverbal	Conversational Exchange	Responding to what another person says (e.g., answering questions or filling in blanks) without direct visual support.
Echoic	Vocal Imitation	Repeating sounds or words made by another person.
Listener Response	Receptive Language	Understanding and responding to spoken language.
Verbal Behavior	Expressive language	Vocal or non-vocal communication to indicate wants, needs, and ideas.
Motivating Operations	Communicative Temptations	The motivation or desire to communicate.
Pairing	Rapport Building/ Following the Child's Lead	Establishing connection and trust with learners through the use of their interests or preferred activities.
Generalization	Carryover/Transfer	The ability to use a skill across different settings, people, and situations.
Discrete Trial Teaching	Drills	Structured teaching method targeting skill acquisition with clear instructions, responses, and reinforcement cycles
Natural Environment Teaching	Incidental Teaching	Contriving learning opportunities in natural contexts usually involving the learner's interests, daily activities, and play, etc.
Shaping	Successive Approximations	Reinforcing gradual steps toward the target behaviors.
Errorless Teaching	Maximal Prompting	Minimizing learner's errors by providing maximal prompts or target responses in early skill acquisitions.

References:

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